

Color at Linus

Color is one of the most powerful visual resources within the application.

Our principles for color are consistent, distinct, and intentional.

Color is applied throughout the UI consistently and has a harmonious relationship between the logo and screens. It creates a distinction between elements, with sufficient contrast between them to meet AA accessibility standards (based on the WCAG 2.0 standards for accessibility). Color is applied deliberately as it expresses meaning in numerous ways, such as relationships between elements (prioritizing or deprioritizing them), degrees of hierarchy, and scoring and statuses. In the Linus application, the strongest color is the **primary blue** (HEX #087DAE) and is used for most interactions, because of the user's need to take action or receive feedback from the system. We use the traffic light color coding (green-yellow-red) mainly to indicate scoring and status; green being used as good or successful and red being used as poor or an alert.

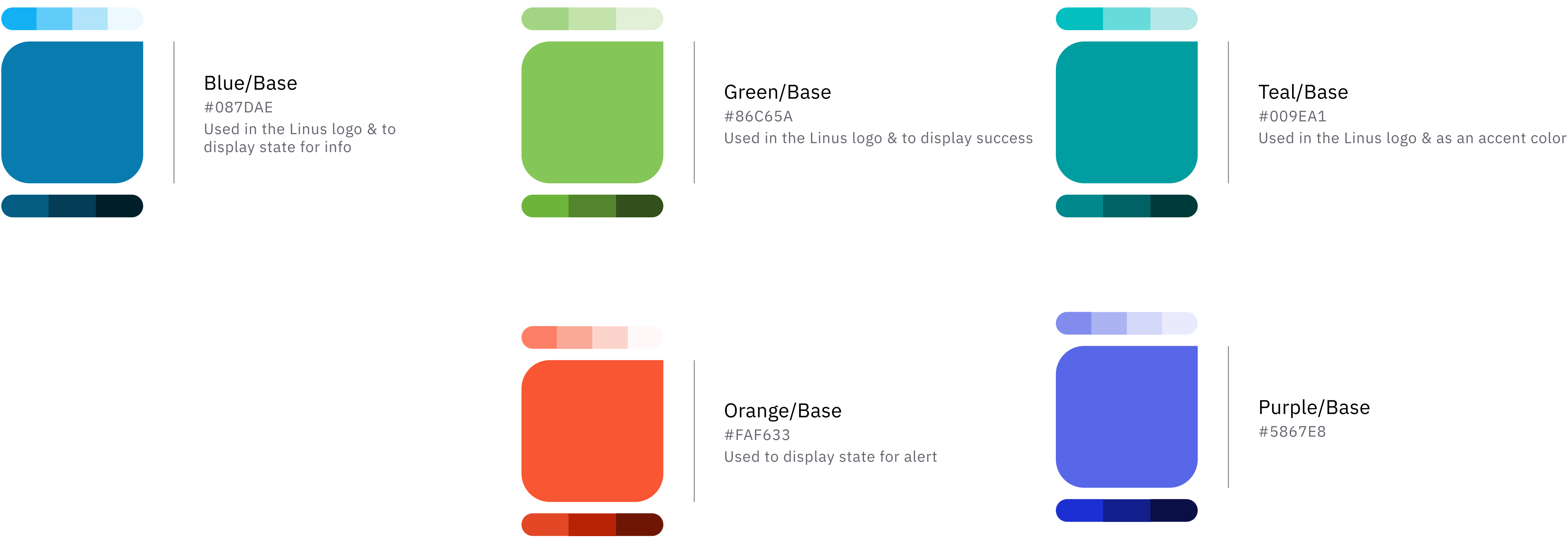
Text Link

Text links are a very simple button type. There are a couple of different ways to show that something is a link. This could be with a **color**, or an **underline**, or the position of the link, or even just the text itself (e.g. "Read more").

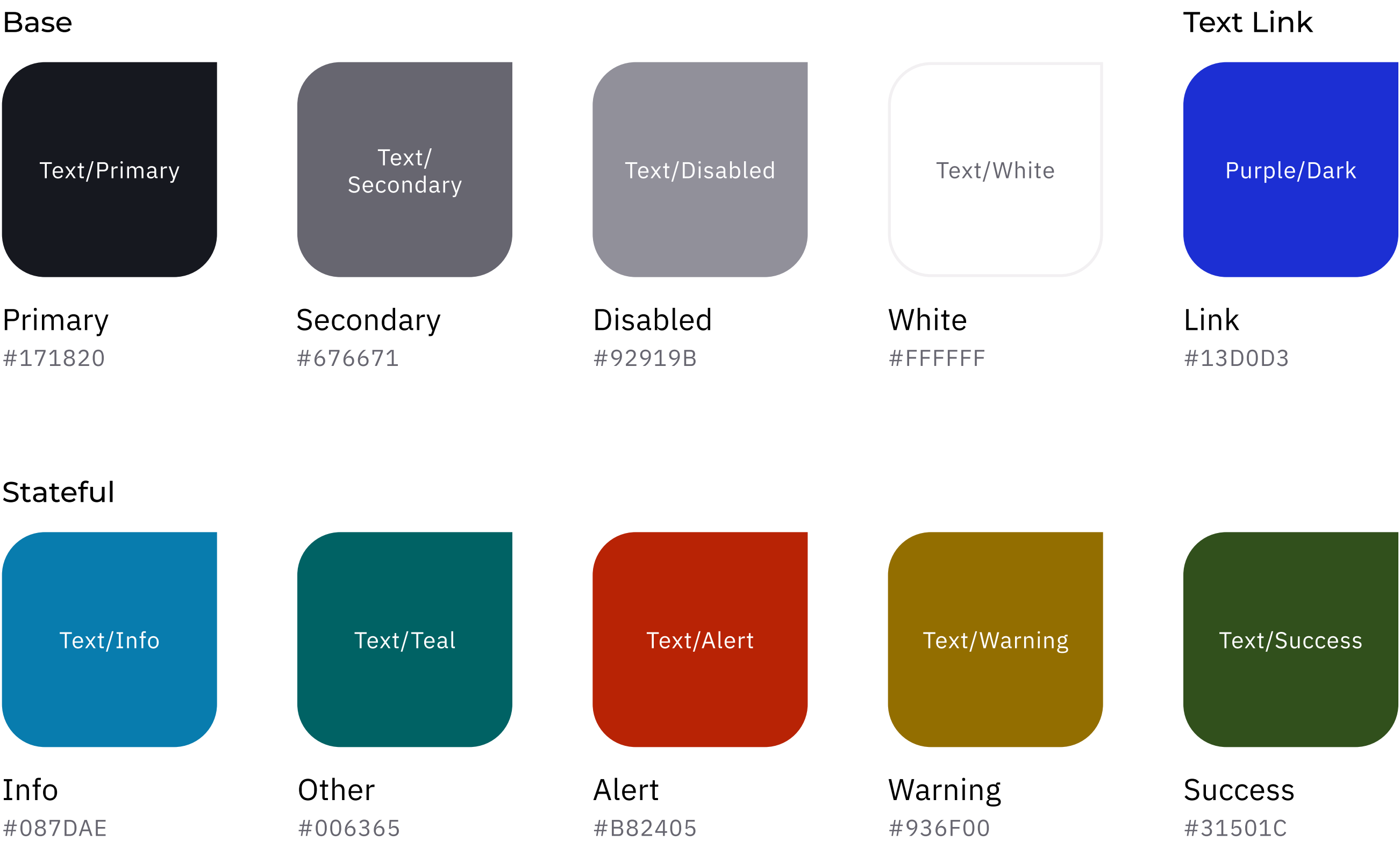
Some history on links and accessibility

When it comes to color, most sites use blue, as it is the most identifiable as a link. Why is the classic text links 'blue'? It goes all the way back to Sir Tim Berners-Lee, inventor of the World Wide Web. While it appears that accessibility wasn't on his mind when he chose the color — the interesting thing about blue is that even people with color blindness can usually still see it.

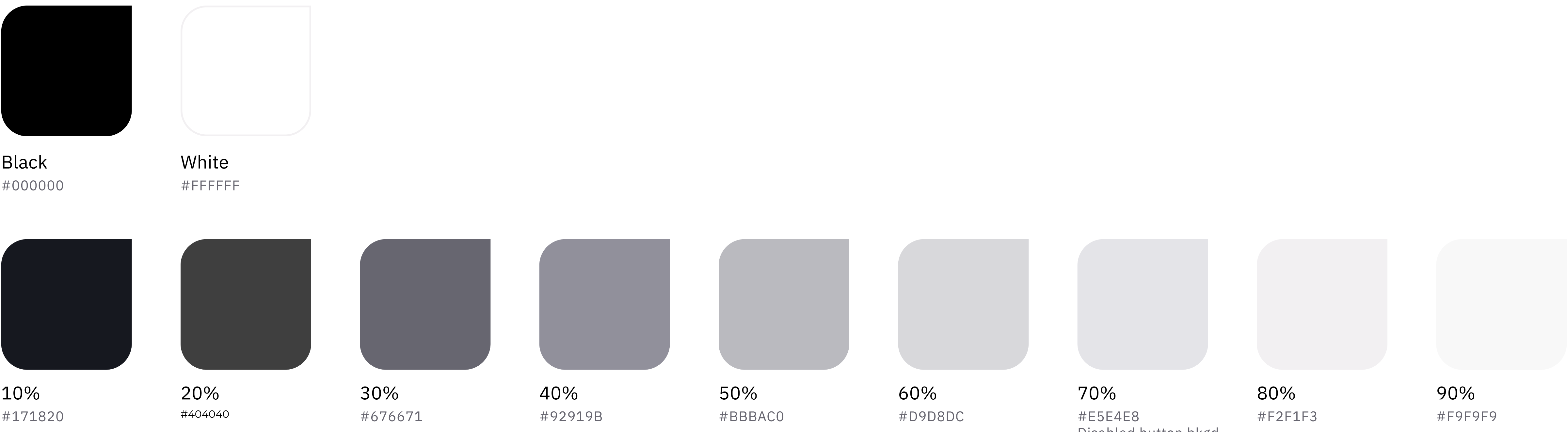
Main app colors



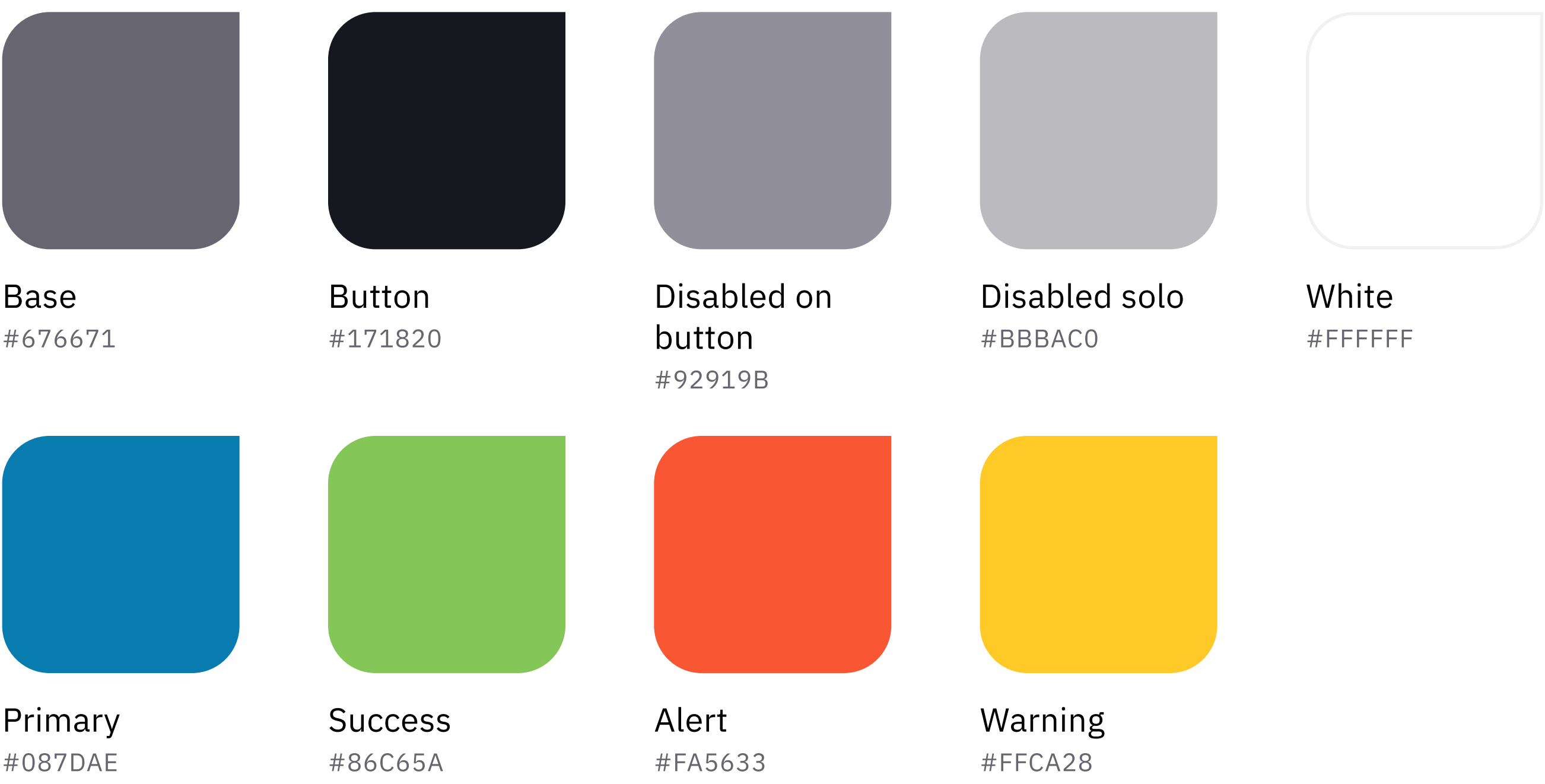
Text labels



Grayscale



Icons

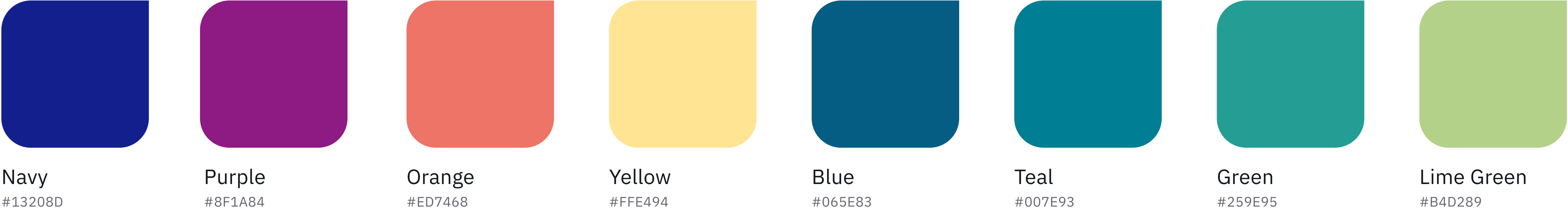


Initials

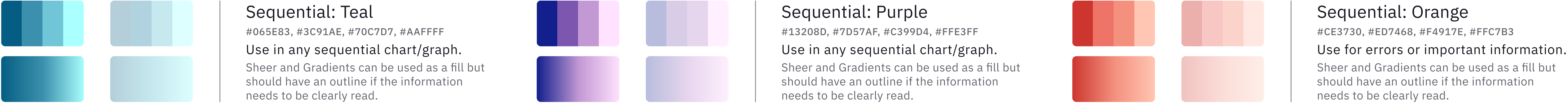


Graphs & Charts

Categorical
The data variable has distinct labels and no natural order.
Create a series of colors that are visually equidistant.



Sequential
The variable is numeric or possesses naturally ordered values.
Darker variation represents a higher value, and a neutral color (even white) will represent a value closer to zero.



Diverging
The variable is numeric and has a significant center value.
For visualizations where you're showing a transition from (a) one extreme, through a (b) neutral middle, and finally to a (c) opposite extreme.

